

MCF

MODERN
CARRY
FEDERATION

Modern Carry Federation Rulebook

Modern Carry Federation

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1.0 Purpose and Identity

1.1 Foundation

MCF is a modernized concealed action pistol sport. MCF emphasizes safety, accessibility, and real-world practicality. It encourages skill development with normal equipment.

"Run what you have, see what works, fix what doesn't."

1.2 Spirit of Concealment

MCF has an intrinsic concealed carry focus, emphasizing practical, daily-carry style gear.

Match officials have leeway to be subjective on equipment if they believe the spirit of the sport is being violated, and a culture of community self-policing is encouraged.

1.3 Real-World Value

MCF stresses speed and accuracy equally, as these two components together represent the foundation of concealed carry skill.

Having one without the other is a deficiency.

1.4 Skills Over Theatrics

Artificial restrictions without real-world value (rigid target priority, magazine retention rules, walkthrough restrictions, etc.) are not part of MCF.

MCF tests shooting skills, not theatrics.

1.5 Modern Relevance

MCF stays relevant with frequent updates in the concealed carry world.

Advancements in carry equipment will be permitted by default unless such equipment represents a safety issue or violates the spirit of concealment.

2.0 Core Tenets

2.1 Safety

MCF has a culture of safety first.

Safety rules are non-negotiable. The serious nature of concealed carry demands the highest standards of firearm handling.

2.2 Personal Growth

MCF provides a fun environment to develop concealed carry skills.

Not every stage must be completely serious, but every match should contain an element of skill development.

2.3 Equity

Course construction and match operation will ensure a similar experience for every competitor.

When issues of equity arise, match officials will determine what corrections are necessary to restore fairness or remove elements causing inequity.

2.4 Sportsmanship

All competitors, including staff, are expected to treat everyone with respect and courtesy.

All participants will display integrity and honesty. Cheating is not permitted.

2.5 Participation

All competitors are expected to help reset stages and assist with match flow.

Volunteers are the foundation of the sport, and gratitude should be shown to those who go above and beyond.

2.6 Community

MCF fosters a sense of community at the local, regional, and national levels.

Everyone is welcome in MCF. New shooters should receive assistance to ensure their safety and success.

3.0 Safety

3.1 Cold Range

All MCF matches operate as a cold range. All firearms must remain unloaded until the competitor is under the supervision of a match official giving commands at the firing position.

Cold firearms may only be handled under official supervision at the firing position or inside a designated safety area.

3.1.1 Unloaded Condition

Outside the course of fire, firearms must be clear of magazines, moon clips, and any other loading device. Hammers must be down, and striker-fired pistols must be in the "fired" condition.

Anyone not meeting these conditions will be escorted to a safety area to correct the issue. If ammunition is inserted into the firearm in any way, the competitor will be disqualified.

3.1.2 Arrival With a Loaded Firearm

A competitor who arrives with a loaded firearm will not receive a DQ provided they proceed immediately and directly to the nearest match official and unload under supervision in a shooting area.

Walking around the range with a loaded firearm under any other circumstances will result in a DQ.

3.1.3 Vehicles

Unloading or removing a holstered firearm inside a vehicle on range property will result in a DQ.

3.2 Safety Areas

All matches must provide a designated, backstopped safety area where competitors may handle unloaded firearms. The area shall have clearly marked boundaries and include a surface for resting equipment. Assembled firearms inside the safety area must always be pointed in a safe direction toward the backstop.

3.2.1 Ammunition Handling

Handling ammunition or ammunition containers inside the safety area will result in a DQ. This includes ammunition boxes, magazines containing ammunition, moon clips, speed loaders, and ammunition cans.

Ammunition may remain on a competitor's belt, in a pouch, or in a pocket, provided it is not handled.

Range bags, backpacks, and carts containing ammunition may be brought into the safety area, provided no ammunition inside them is handled.

Empty magazines and magazine weight inserts may be handled in the safety area. Snap caps and empty cartridge cases are considered ammunition and will result in a DQ.

Snap caps and empty cartridge cases are considered ammunition. Handling them in a safety area or inserting them into a firearm will result in a DQ.

4.0 Range Commands

The following commands shall be given when the competitor is in the designated start position.

4.1 Standard Commands

4.1.1 Make Ready

Upon this command, and only this command, the competitor is authorized to draw their firearm, dry fire, practice reloads, take sight pictures, and load the firearm in preparation for the course of fire. This command begins the course of fire. Any action after this command and before the "Range Is Clear" command is considered part of the course of fire. Before holstering, the competitor must engage the firearm's primary external safety, if it has one.

4.1.2 Are You Ready?

After the competitor has completed the make-ready process and settled into the start position, the Range Officer will ask for verbal or physical confirmation that the competitor is ready. Silence will be interpreted as confirmation. If the competitor is not ready, they may indicate that to the Range Officer and be directed to unload before attempting the course later.

4.1.3 Standby

After the "Are You Ready?" confirmation, and once the competitor is motionless in the start position, the Range Officer will wait approximately 1-3 seconds before giving the start signal.

4.1.4 Start Signal

The start signal may be audible (timer beep) or visual (light). Once the signal is given, the competitor may draw the firearm and engage targets. If the competitor moves prematurely, the Range Officer will stop and reset them.

4.1.5 If You Are Finished, Unload, Show Clear

When the competitor appears to have concluded firing, the Range Officer will issue this command. The competitor may continue to engage targets, after which the Range Officer will repeat the command. When finished, the competitor will remove all loading devices and present the firearm with its action visibly open for inspection. The Range Officer will visually verify the firearm's condition, but the competitor remains responsible for ensuring that it is unloaded.

4.1.6 If Clear, Hammer Down/Cylinder Closed, Holster

After completing the inspection, the Range Officer will issue this command. For a semiautomatic firearm, the competitor must close the action on an empty chamber, point the firearm in a safe direction, pull the trigger, and holster. A decocking lever does not replace the required trigger pull. After showing an empty cylinder, a revolver competitor will close the cylinder and holster without pulling the trigger.

4.1.7 Range Is Clear

Once the competitor's firearm is safely cleared and holstered, this command is given to end the course of fire and allow scoring to take place.

4.2 Additional Commands

4.2.1 Stop

If the Range Officer identifies a construction problem, safety violation, or other reason the course of fire cannot continue, they will command "Stop." The competitor must stop moving and shooting immediately, keep the firearm pointed in a safe direction, and await further commands. The Range Officer will then issue the normal unloading commands.

4.2.2 Finger

If the Range Officer identifies a potential finger in the trigger guard, they may elect to issue a warning, particularly in the case of a newer competitor. This is an optional courtesy given at the RO's best judgment, and egregious infractions may go directly to a stage DQ outlined in Section 9.2. Repeated violations will also escalate to a stage DQ. Receipt of this warning command is not a requirement before incurring a stage DQ.

4.2.3 Coaching

If a newer competitor requests coaching, the RO may issue additional commands to assist them through the stage.

5.0 Stage Design

Stages should test practical shooting skills while remaining safe, understandable, and reasonably equitable for every competitor. Each stage must provide enough information for competitors and match officials to identify the shooting area, required scoring hits, start condition, and any stage-specific procedures.

5.1 Construction

5.1.1 Round Count

Stages will require a minimum of 4 scoring hits and may require no more than 32 scoring hits.

The required round count is based on scoring hits, not the number of shots a competitor actually fires. Competitors may fire additional shots unless the written stage briefing states otherwise.

5.1.2 Vision Barriers

Stages may use walls, barrels, and other objects as impenetrable vision barriers. Unless otherwise stated, objects over 5 feet tall extend upward as an infinite plane and cannot be shot over or through.

Vision barriers should make the intended shooting challenge clear. Their placement should not create uncertainty about whether a target is available from a particular position.

5.1.3 Shooting Area

The stage must define clear shooting areas from which shots may be fired. Boundaries must be visible and arranged so competitors can reasonably identify them while moving through the stage.

Shots fired while the competitor is standing outside the shooting area are penalized on a per-shot basis. A stage may require the competitor to remain inside the shooting area, but that requirement must be stated clearly in the written stage briefing.

5.1.4 Safety

Stage designers and match officials must identify and correct unsafe engagement angles, movement paths, and target placements before the stage is used.

Targets must not be available for engagement beyond the 180-degree safety line. Steel targets must not be placed where they can be engaged from within 21 feet.

Props, walls, fault lines, and start positions should guide competitors toward safe firearm handling without requiring a single prescribed solution unless the stage specifically permits one under Section 5.1.5.

5.1.5 Freestyle

Stages are freestyle unless the written stage briefing states otherwise. Competitors may determine the order in which they engage targets and the positions from which they engage them, subject to the shooting-area boundaries and safety rules.

No more than one stage per match may require a fixed target-engagement order or fixed shooting positions. Any fixed order or position must be described clearly in the written stage briefing.

5.1.6 Activated Targets

Activated targets must operate repeatably and consistently. Competitors may not set up or practice activated targets during the course of fire. Match staff may provide one or two brief demonstrations at the beginning of the squad walkthrough.

5.1.7 Construction Failures

If a prop or construction failure cannot be corrected in a way that provides an equitable experience for all competitors, the stage will be removed from match scoring.

6.0 Divisions

Divisions group competitors by firearm capacity rather than by individual firearm features. A competitor's division determines the maximum ammunition capacity permitted in each magazine or cylinder and at the start of a course of fire.

Capacity limits are maximums, not required loading levels. A competitor may load fewer rounds than the division permits, however, a competitor may not download a magazine to fit the Small Capacity division. The firearm loading devices need to have come from the factory as 8 rounds or less.

6.1 Modern Capacity

Modern Capacity represents contemporary carry setups using higher-capacity firearms.

- Maximum magazine capacity: 25 rounds + 1 initial barney

There are no division-specific restrictions on magwells, ports, compensators, optics, sights, firearm size, firearm weight, or other features.

6.2 Factory Capacity

Factory Capacity represents typical factory-capacity configurations.

- Maximum magazine capacity: 18 rounds + 1 initial barney

There are no division-specific restrictions on magwells, ports, compensators, optics, sights, firearm size, firearm weight, or other features.

6.3 Small Capacity

Small Capacity represents lower-capacity firearms, including micro-compact pistols and revolvers.

- Maximum magazine or cylinder capacity: 8 rounds + 1 initial barney

There are no division-specific restrictions on magwells, ports, compensators, optics, sights, firearm weight, or other features.

Positive scoring hits in this division receive the adjustment defined in Section 8.3.

7.0 Equipment

MCF equipment rules are intended to accommodate practical concealed-carry setups without restrictive divisions.

Competitors are responsible for ensuring that their equipment is safe, serviceable, and appropriate for use throughout the match.

7.1 Restrictions

Advancements in carry equipment are permitted by default unless the equipment presents a safety issue or violates the spirit of concealment.

The absence of a specific equipment rule should not be interpreted as a prohibition. Match officials should begin with the presumption that equipment is permitted and restrict it only when they can identify a safety concern or a clear conflict with the concealed-carry identity of the sport.

7.2 Official Review

When equipment eligibility is uncertain, a match official may inspect the equipment and issue a subjective and authoritative decision. Match directors must be careful to strike a delicate balance between allowing real carry setups versus preventing unrealistic setups that violate the spirit of the sport.

7.3 Holster and Bagged Carry

Pocket and bagged carry are permitted, provided that they have some sort of cover within the pocket or bag over the trigger guard to prevent the trigger from being activated, and the firearm will never break the 180 while loaded and in the pocket/bag. All range rules apply, if the range disallows these carry methods, they cannot be used in the match.

8.0 Scoring

8.1 Cardboard Target Scoring

Cardboard targets may be any shape, but must contain three distinct scoring zones: Alpha, Charlie, and Delta. Each target must be at least 10 inches tall and 6 inches wide.

At least 4 square inches of the Alpha zone must be available to score.

Scoring targets must be a shade of brown. No-shoot targets must be a shade of white. Hard cover must be a shade of black.

The Alpha zone may be divided into separate scoring areas, such as a torso and head box.

Zone	Value
Alpha	5
Charlie	3
Delta	1

8.1.1 Line Breaks

Hits touching a scoring line receive the higher scoring value. This also applies to no-shoot targets.

8.2 Steel Target Scoring

Steel targets may be falling plates or poppers. A plate must measure at least 6 inches across its smallest scoring dimension. If a hit fails to knock over a steel target, the hit will count when sufficient evidence establishes that the target was struck. Each steel target is worth 1 Alpha, regardless of division.

8.3 Small Capacity Division

The point value of each positive scoring hit is doubled. No-shoot penalties are not doubled. Doubling affects score value only; the competitor must still make every scoring hit required by the stage.

Examples:

- 1 Alpha = 10 points
- 1 Charlie = 6 points
- 1 Delta = 2 points

8.4 Penalties

Each occurrence of a penalty-including violating the written stage briefing, firing a shot while outside the shooting area, recording a miss, or hitting a no-shoot target-deducts 10 points. When a violation involves multiple shots or hits, the penalty applies separately to each applicable shot or hit.

9.0 Disqualifications

A match disqualification (Match DQ) removes a competitor from further participation in the match and is reserved for serious safety or behavioral violations. A stage disqualification (Stage DQ) removes the competitor's score for the relevant stage, which will be recorded as "Did Not Fire" (DNF).

Any match official overseeing the course of fire may issue a DQ. The Range Officer (RO) will immediately command "Stop," and the Range Master (RM) must confirm the DQ. If the RM reverses the DQ, the competitor will receive a reshoot.

9.1 Match Disqualifications

Match DQs include:

- Inserting ammunition into a firearm outside the course of fire.
- Walking around the range with a loaded firearm without proceeding immediately and directly to a match official for supervised unloading.
- Unloading or removing a holstered firearm inside a vehicle on range property.
- Handling a firearm outside an official safety area without being under official instruction.
- Handling ammunition or ammunition containers inside a safety area, including snap caps and empty cases.
- Breaking the 180-degree safety plane.
- Dropping a loaded firearm.
- Pointing a firearm at any person, including the competitor. Incidental muzzle coverage of the competitor's body below the waist during the draw or reholster is excluded.
- Unsportsmanlike conduct.
- Intentionally modifying stage construction.
- Participating while impaired.

9.2 Stage Disqualifications

Stage DQs include:

- Dropping an unloaded firearm.
- Placing a finger inside the trigger guard outside of target engagement.
- Holstering a firearm without engaging its primary safety mechanism, if it has one.
- Intentionally taking an action that the Range Master or Match Director (MD) determines created a dangerous situation.
- Intentionally causing a reshoot.

- Failing to help reset stages after an official warning.

10.0 Match Administration

Match officials are responsible for safe and equitable match operation. They may make corrections necessary to restore fairness or remove sources of inequity.

10.1 Match Leadership

Match leadership is responsible for organizing the match, assigning officials, and ensuring that stages can be administered under these rules. Safety concerns take priority over schedule, scoring, and competitive considerations.

Match leadership may correct or remove a stage condition that creates an unsafe or inequitable experience.

10.2 Range Officers

The Range Officer (RO) will supervise competitors during each course of fire, issue the prescribed range commands, and maintain control of the shooting area. They are responsible for stopping a course of fire when they observe a safety problem, construction failure, or other condition that prevents the stage from continuing properly. Any ruling by a range officer may be escalated to another RO, and then finally to the Rangemaster.

10.3 Rangemaster

The Range Master (RM) handles the operations around shooting at the match. The RM is the highest level for RO escalation. They have the final authority on safety and scoring calls. Any other disputes may go to arbitration.

10.4 Match Director

The Match Director is equal to the RM in authority, but handles the administration of the match versus the management of shooting. There is some crossover between the RM and MD, and they can substitute for each other as needed, or be combined at smaller matches.

10.5 Arbitration

If the competitor disagrees with something other than a scoring call, they supply \$100 to the MD and present their case to a committee of 3 shooters pulled from a separate, uninvolved squad. If the competitor loses arbitration, the \$100 is forfeited to the match. If they win, the fee is returned and a scoring modification or reshoot is granted as needed.

10.6 Competitor Responsibilities

Competitors must:

- Follow match-official instructions and range commands.
- Understand the written stage briefing before beginning a course of fire.

- Handle firearms and ammunition in accordance with the safety rules.
- Treat staff and other competitors with respect.
- Assist with stage reset and match flow.

10.7 Consistency and Equity

Stage briefings, scoring standards, and procedural requirements should be applied consistently to every competitor. When an unexpected condition affects a competitor, match officials should determine whether the condition also affected safety, scoring, or the intended shooting challenge before deciding how to proceed.

Any correction should be explained to the affected competitor and communicated to match staff who may encounter the same condition.

Appendix: Glossary and Examples

Glossary

Cold range: A range where firearms remain unloaded except under a match official's supervision at the firing position.

Match DQ: Disqualification that removes a competitor from further participation in the match.

Stage DQ: Disqualification that removes a competitor's score for a single stage without removing them from the match.

Range Officer: The match official who supervises a competitor during a course of fire and issues range commands.

Safety area: A designated, backstopped area where competitors may handle unloaded firearms, but not ammunition.